



**HKU
Med**

School of Clinical Medicine
Department of Medicine
香港大學內科學系

MBBS IV- General Clerkship (Block A) 2025/26

**Orientation
25 September, 2025**

**Prof KC Teo
Coordinator of General Clerkship (Block A)
(Department of Medicine)**



Aim

Be able to integrate the history and physical signs of the clinical problem to arrive at a clinical diagnosis or an appropriate list of differential diagnosis; and formulate a plan for further investigations and therapeutic management.



Rotation Schedule (Week 1-16)

Week	Groups 1-7	Groups 8-14	Components
1	Fundamentals of Medicine		
2-8	CVS/ Neuro/ Resp	Endo/ GI/ Haem/ Nephro	Monday: Whole Class Lectures Tuesday to Friday: Small Group Teaching Sessions
	HKU-SZH Attachment	GH Attachment (Rheum & Immune/ Ophthalmology)	Monday: Whole Class Lectures Tuesday to Friday: Small Group Teaching Sessions
1st day of Week 8	Mid-of-rotation Assessment: Clinical Skills Assessment		
9-15	Endo/ GI/ Haem/ Nephro	CVS/ Neuro/ Resp	Monday: Whole Class Lectures Tuesday to Friday: Small Group Teaching Sessions
	GH Attachment (Rheum & Immune/ Ophthalmology)	HKU SZH Attachment	Monday: Whole Class Lectures Tuesday to Friday: Small Group Teaching Sessions
16	End-of-rotation Assessment: Data Interpretation Assessment Clinical Skills Assessment		



Whole-class Recordings (E-learning)

- Students must engage with these videos to better prepare for the teaching and learning activities within the GC curriculum.
- All online lectures have been classified based on specialty and recommended sequence to watch.
 - 1) Watch by system
 - 2) 4-7 recommended lecture list to watch per week (minimum requirement)
- **By the end of week 6**, students are required to complete 40% of the class recordings. Failing to do so: Written explanation and strategies for improvement.
- **By the end of week 14**, students are required to complete 80% of the class recordings. Failing to do so: Meeting and counselling session with the Teaching & Learning Committee
- In addition to the watching list per week, students are advised to go through videos of relevant specialty before teaching clinics for better learning experience.



Learning Activities

Department of Medicine

1. Fundamentals of Medicine
2. Teaching Clinics
3. Data Interpretation
4. Clinical Pharmacology
5. Bedside Teaching
(QMH, GH, HHH, KWH, PYNEH, QEH, RH, TMH, TWH, YCH)
6. Clinical Skills Sessions (QMH, GH, TWH)
7. Friday Out-patients Clinic teaching sessions (QMH)
8. Sub-specialty OPD attachment (QMH)
9. Attachment in HKU-Shenzhen Hospital (HKU-SZH)
10. Attachment in Grantham Hospital (GH)
11. Interactive Tutorials
12. Dermatology



Learning Activities

Department of Medicine

1. Fundamentals of Medicine

2. Teaching Clinics

3. Data Interpretation

4. Clinical Pharmacology

5. Bedside Teaching (QMH, GH, **80% Attendance**, YCH)

6. Clinical Skills Sessions (QMH, GH, TWH)

7. Friday Out-patients Clinic teaching sessions (QMH)

8. Sub-specialty OPD attachment (QMH)

9. Attachment in HKU-Shenzhen Hospital (HKU-SZH)

10. Attachment in Grantham Hospital (GH)

11. Interactive Tutorials

12. Dermatology



1. Fundamentals of Medicine (@2 hours)

Learning Outcomes

- To describe and interpret the common investigations in clinical medicine.
- To apply relevant investigations based on patient's clinical history and physical examination for diagnosis.
- To recognize the fundamentals in clinical pharmacology especially drug interactions, adverse drug reactions and pharmacogenomics.

Format

- Whole Class Lectures



2. Teaching Clinics (@1.5 hours)

Learning Outcomes

- To understand and manage medical problems on integrated wholistic approach.
- To allow more detailed discussions on the clinical approach to the diagnosis, investigation, acute and long-term management of clinical problems.

Format

- Whole Class Lectures
- To emphasis on active student participation and interactive discussions rather than didactic lecturing.



3. Data Interpretation (@2 hours)

Learning Outcomes

- To learn the interpretation of clinical data with reference to the history and physical findings.
- To analysis of the medical problems of the cases

Format

- Whole Class Lectures
- Students will be shown a few case scenarios where appropriate investigations have been performed.
- Students will be asked to find out how these investigations may supplement the history and physician examination in reaching a diagnosis.



4. Clinical Pharmacology (@2 hours)

Learning Outcomes

- To learn the commonly encountered day-to-day issues in Clinical Pharmacology and Therapeutics.

Format

- Whole Class Lectures



5. Bedside Teaching (QMH@2.5 hours) (GH, KWH, PYNEH, QEH, RH, TWH, YCH @2 hours) (HHH & TMH)

Learning Outcomes

- To obtain a full medical and social history, complete a full physical examination, and integrate findings for diagnostic and management purposes.

Format

- This will be conducted in medical wards, with direct interaction with patients.
- Students will clerk the patient and present the history and physical examination findings to the teacher, who will question and discuss the history with students and check the physical signs.
- Format of HHH & TMH: Please refer to the timetable



6. Clinical Skills Session (QMH, GH, TWH) (@3 hours)

Learning Outcomes	▪ To further develop the clinical skills of physical examination in patients with clinical problems of specific organ systems: cardiovascular, respiratory, renal/abdominal and neurological system.
Format	▪ Patient-based sessions.



7. Friday Out-patients Clinic Teaching Sessions (QMH) (@3.5 hours)

Learning Outcomes	▪ To assess the importance or otherwise of patients' symptoms, pick up relevant physical signs and discuss the provisional diagnosis, initial investigations and management of the patients.
Format	▪ To clerk 1-2 outpatients seeking medical consultations and present their findings to a physician.



8. Sub-specialty OPD Attachment (QMH/GHK) (@2 hours) /

Learning Outcomes	▪ To observe how physicians manage patients with different medical problems at the out-patient setting at or outside university hospital environment.
Format	▪ 2-3 students will be assigned to attach to subspecialty out-patient clinics / procedure

Please be well-prepared before attending the subspecialty clinic.



9. Attachment in HKU-Shenzhen Hospital (HKU-SZH) (@Tue to Fri)

Learning Outcomes	▪ To apply the clinical approach to various presentations and appreciate the diversity of clinical conditions ▪ To consolidate the clinical skills for conducting full set of physical examination ▪ To relate the clinical scenarios and recognize those when input by specific disciplines is needed (e.g., infectious disease specialist, rheumatologist) ▪ To compare and contrast the healthcare settings between public hospital in Hong Kong and HKUSZH in mainland China ▪ To appreciate the cultural and linguistic features in the patient-doctor relationship in mainland China
Format	▪ Small group visit and observation. ▪ e.g. Bedside, SOPD, Ward Rounds, Simulation, Endoscopy etc.



9. Attachment in HKU-Shenzhen Hospital (HKU-SZH) (@Tue to Fri)

Transport

- By Shuttle.
Further details will be provided for each group before the attachment.

Accommodation

- In HKU-SZH.
Further details will be provided for each group before the attachment.



HKU-SZH

Travel Insurance and Emergency Assistance

- Please note that the University would only provide standard travel insurance coverage for overseas trips or study abroad programmes approved/arranged by the University. Before leaving Hong Kong, students are strongly advised to arrange their own travel insurance to better suit their needs, especially if you are planning to travel beyond the official programme period for personal leisure purposes.
- Details of HKU's Travel Insurance coverage at HKU Portal: SIS Menu → Financial Services → FEO Info and Hotlines → Finance and Enterprises Office → Insurance Information for Students

Coverage	Maximum Benefits per Person Travel Insurance
Accidental Death or permanent disablement	HK\$1,000,000
Medical expenses	HK\$500,000



HKU-SZH Travel Insurance and Emergency Assistance

- The University has engaged the Inter Partner Assistance Hong Kong Ltd. (“IPA”) to provide general assistance, local information such as nearby clinic/pharmacy, police station, translation services, etc., or travel advice to all HKU students travelling outside of Hong Kong.
- IPA provides 24/7 support to students, you can create a user name and password via the portal and download the APP when you are going abroad.
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- The IPA 24/7 Assistance Center hotline is +852 2861 9266, HKU membership number is “39379”.
- Students are strongly advised to create an account using HKU email address at [IPA Registration](#) before travelling outside of Hong Kong.





HKU-SZH **Travelling Document**

- Please make sure you hold a valid permit/visa for travelling to Shenzhen.
- For application or renewal of the Home Return Permit, please contact the CTS Entry Permit Service Hong Kong Limited (中旅社) as soon as possible.
- If you hold a foreign passport, you will need to apply for a visa for cultural exchanges, visits and study tours in China (F visa). The Department will assist in providing an invitation letter issued by HKU-SZH as a supporting document for your visa application. Please contact the Department of Medicine via email (teachmed@hku.hk) as soon as possible.



HKU-SZH Others

- Please watch the video clip of “Demonstration of HKU-SZH Teaching”.
- The link would be included in Handbook/ Timetable.
- You are strongly advised to set up WeChat/ Alipay for payment in HKU-SZH.



HKU-SZH Update Emergency Contact on SIS

- You are advised to update the emergency contacts on students' SIS before the one-day clinical attachment in HKU-SZH.
- Go to HKU Portal > Self Service > Change Contact Information
- Under “Emergency Contact”, update the information
- Click “Save & Back”

The screenshot displays the HKU SIS Self Services portal. On the left is a navigation menu with categories: Self Services, Enrollment, Timetables and Events, and Academic Records. The 'Self Services' menu is expanded, showing options like 'Change Contact Information'. The main content area is titled 'Personal Particulars - Biographical' and contains several sections: 'Student ID', 'Emergency Contact', 'Contact Address', and 'Phone Numbers'. The 'Emergency Contact' section is highlighted with a red border and contains fields for '*Contact Name' and '*Relationship' (set to 'Mother'). Below this is a red note about parental consent for students under 18. The 'Contact Address' section has fields for '*Address 1', 'Address 2', and 'Address 3'. The 'Phone Numbers' section has fields for '*Contact Phone Number', 'Mobile Phone Number', and 'Home Phone Number'. A 'Save & Back' button is located at the bottom of the form.

Self Services
Student Center
Request Temporary Adviser
Change Contact Information
Student Card Document Upload
Report Lost/ Damaged Card
Guide to Reveal SIS Menu Links

Enrollment
Declare Major/Minor/Special
Course Information
Course Effectiveness Profile
Enrollment Add Classes
Enrollment Drop Classes
Enrollment Status
Common Core Queue Position
My Course History
Examinations Timetable

Timetables and Events*
HKU Event Calendar (Timetable*)
My Weekly Schedule*
Download Class Timetable*

Academic Records
View My Grades

Personal Particulars - Biographical

Student ID: [Redacted]

Emergency Contact

*Contact Name: [Redacted]
*Relationship: Mother

(Note: For students who will be under the age of 18 at the start of the First Semester, please make sure that the name and contact details of the emergency contact person is the same as that of the parent/guardian who has signed/will sign the parental/guardian consent form for you. If it is detected that there is a discrepancy in respect of the information provided, the University will by default change the name and contact details of the emergency contact person to that of the parent/guardian who has signed the parental/guardian form.)

Contact Address

*Address 1: [Redacted]
Address 2: [Redacted]
Address 3: [Redacted]

Phone Numbers

*Contact Phone Number: [Redacted]
Mobile Phone Number: [Redacted]
Home Phone Number: [Redacted]

Save & Back



10. Attachment in Grantham Hospital (GH) (@Thu AM)

Learning Outcomes	<u>Rheumatology and Clinical Immunology</u> ▪ To recognize the modalities, indications and contraindications to commonly used biologics in rheumatology/immunology ▪ To appreciate the diagnostic and therapeutic modalities of musculoskeletal ultrasound for rheumatic disorders
Format	<u>Rheumatology and Clinical Immunology</u> ▪ Small group visit and observation of Biologics/Ultrasound Clinics at the Rheumatology & Clinical Immunology Unit.

Weekly Schedule @ Grantham Hospital

	Mon @ QMH	Tue @ GH	Wed @ GH	Thu @ GH	Fri @ GH
AM	Lectures	Ophthalmology	Ophthalmology	Biologics and Ultrasound Clinic	Ophthalmology
PM		Ophthalmology	/	Ophthalmology	Ophthalmology



11. Interactive Tutorials(@2 hours)

Learning Outcomes

- To emphasize on basic anatomical, physiological and biochemical principles of diseases.
- Eight disciplines will be covered: cardiology, endocrinology, gastroenterology, haematology, nephrology, neurology, respiratory medicine, rheumatology

Format

- Students will be given the tutorial materials at the beginning of the clerkship.
- Students are expected to study the clinical scenarios (from Moodle) before the respective sessions and prepare for discussion with the teacher and the group during the sessions.



12. Dermatology Sessions (STD session@3 hours; PBL session @2 hours; Bedside @1 hour; OPD@2 hours; Pictorial Tour@1 hour)

Learning Outcomes

- To diagnose common STD and related complications
- To learn the problem-based approach on Common dermatological complaints with slides presentations.
- To take a history for skin complaints & assess compliance of skin treatment
- To have pictorial tour on Common Dermatoses and Cutaneous manifestations of medical diseases.

Format

- Lectures/ Tutorial/ Bedside/ OPD sessions



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Assessments



Clinical Skills Assessment

- There are two Clinical Skills Assessments (CSA) throughout the 16-week rotation.
- The 1st CSA is scheduled in the mid-of-rotation (week 8); the 2nd CSA is scheduled in the end-of-rotation (week 16).
- In the 1st CSA, students will be assessed by an examiner on one of the systems (Abd, CVS, Neuro & Resp).
- In the 2nd CSA, students will be assessed by another examiner on a different system from the 1st CSA (Abd, CVS, Neuro & Resp).
- 8 minutes for physical examination & 2 minutes for discussion.
- Emphasize on how the physical signs are elicited and the correct technique.



Data Interpretation Assessment

- To be scheduled in the end-of-rotation (week 16).
- Short Answers Questions x 3 questions: One ECG, one Imaging, and one Laboratory Data Interpretation.
- Multiple Choice Questions x 5 questions: simulation cases, bedside procedures and acute medicine.
- Duration: 40 minutes
- To be completed via Moodle with iPads fitted with keyboards in lecture theatres.
- Further details will be provided in due course.



Weighting of Assessment components:

- Data Interpretation assessment: 20%
- 1st and 2nd Clinical Skills Assessment: 30%
- Continuous assessment -> attendance and grading of all learning activities and Logbook: 50%



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Important notes for students



Attendance

- Students should attend all learning sessions, as are prescribed in the timetable and sign the attendance sheet for each lesson (if any). **Students should be warned that signing attendance** for another person is considered forgery and it is a **serious misconduct** which may result in disciplinary actions.

Assessment

- Continuous assessment based on grading of student's performance and attendance in each teaching session and the logbook.
- Data Interpretation Assessment in the end-of-rotation.
- Clinical Skills Assessments in the mid-of-rotation and the end-of-rotation.

Leave of Absence

- Students who are absent from a session on medical grounds are required to submit the relevant proof to the School Office within 7 days of that session for approval.



General Rules

Students should:

- **observe the rules and regulations** of respective medical units during their clinical teaching activities and minimize disturbance to patient care/clinical services.
- **demonstrate professionalism** during bedside teaching activities and respect all patients, teachers and other clinical staff.
- **ask for permission** from relevant staff when borrowing equipment or stationery from wards and properly return these items after use.
- **perform hand hygiene** before and after clerking patients.
- **ensure that the bedside hand-rails are raised** after examination on patients to reduce risk of falls.
- **only bring minimal items which would be used in wards** when attending clinical teaching. All other personal belongings should be left in lockers.
- Students should not leave any personal belongings unattended in wards/ treatment rooms/ lecture rooms.



Infection Control

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Wear PPE in clinical area when necessary
- Care should be taken in both putting on clean PPE properly and timely removal of contaminated PPE without contamination of the staff themselves and the environment.
- Discard into a lidded rubbish bin.



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Code of Conduct

PATIENT CONFIDENTIALITY



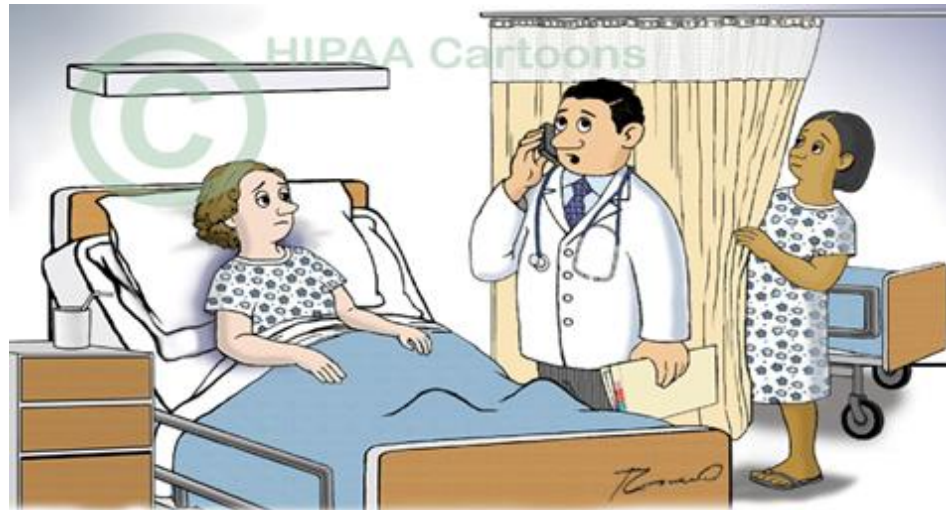
Students are **prohibited** from:

- taking patient records away from the wards/ clinics or capturing the records in any formats, i.e. taking photo of patients records from CMS, even for learning purpose.
- taking photos/videos whatsoever in clinical areas.
- disclosing, in various means of oral or written format, by telephone or fax, or electronically, any medical information in connection with the management of a patient. Sharing of info/images via social media or instant messaging applications.



Code of Conduct

PATIENT CONFIDENTIALITY



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"Sure, I'm free to talk. Yes, I remember you, Mr. Barnes. You're that 58 year old executive at National Bank. Emergency? Ok, I'll call in a Viagra refill for you."

Note: disclosure of patients information may be done unintentionally if you talk/ discuss freely in public areas of the hospital/ clinic.



Code of Conduct

PATIENT CONFIDENTIALITY

Access to HA Filmless Image:

- Students should **seek permission** from the patient and ward staff concerned before accessing to any clinical data.
- Students would only have access to the CMS/ePR of the patients via the CMS workstations at the designated clinical areas and that records would be logged.



Code of Conduct

PATIENT CONFIDENTIALITY

Patients have the right to decide what happens to their own bodies.
Students should:

- **consult** the tutors/ward managers/nurses on duty in wards for advice.
- obtain **valid consent** from the patients before starting any clinical enquiry or examination, and patients have a right to refuse.
- conduct history taking or examination with **due care** to the **patient's dignity** and **comfort**.
- **thank** the patient; restore the clothing or positioning of the patient to his/her original or desirable status; put back files/records properly.



Code of Conduct

CHAPERONE POLICY FOR PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

CLINICAL CHAPERONE is a person who has a role to **witness** and **safeguard** both doctor (student) and patient during physical examination.

- A female chaperone is required to be present for physical examination of female patients by male students.
- The chaperone should have the **knowledge** to **assess the appropriateness of the physical examination/procedure** as well as the way in which they are done.
- Adequate “screening” during physical examination requiring patient body exposure, the chaperone should be **in the sight of the patient**.
- Students should **provide clear explanation** and **seek the consent** from the patient concerned before physical examination.



ATTIRE

- Students should **dress properly** on all learning occasions as a matter of respect to the teaching activities, your peers, the teachers and yourself.
- For clinical encounters (e.g. clerking a patient), students should **wear a white coat with the appropriate professional attire and your name badge.**
- Appropriate attire refers to what would inspire confidence of an average patient in our community regarding you as a healthcare professional.



PROFESSIONALISM

- Attire matters: Neat white coat with a name tag
- Respect your patients' privacy, be mindful of ward environment
- Speak professionally: Tone, volume and pace; avoid jargons
- Inform the patient clearly what you would like to do and around how much time it would take
- Do not panic when patients ask questions that you are uncertain of
- It's okay to let the patients know you are not sure, and that they can direct the question to their doctors
- Phones down, focus up: Be attentive to your patients; if you need to answer a phone call or reply to a message, excuse yourself and step aside before doing so
- Return all bedside settings to their original position e.g. bed rails, bed position, table, blankets etc.
- Always show courtesy to patients and be grateful for their help
- DO NOT take photos in hospital premises



YOUR WELLNESS

- You're not alone!
- Always remember every role / position has its own limitation
- Seek help from your teachers and/or examiners if you **encounter problems during bedside teachings including examinations** (e.g. difficult or uncooperative patients, change in patient conditions)
- Talk with people you trust and vent your feelings and thoughts; this could help take some burden off your shoulders!
- Seek help from Departmental Coordinators or Administrators if needed.



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